

LOS ANGELES CHARGERS INTEL REPORT

2026 training camp edition — Mike McDaniel arrives to fix a broken offensive line, Jim Harbaugh faces Year 2 pressure, and redemption begins now.

UPDATED
July 25, 2026

11–6

2025 RECORD

3–16

WILD CARD LOSS TO NE

60 Sacks

2025 CATASTROPHE

Mike McDaniel

NEW OFFENSIVE
COORDINATOR

OL Overhaul

TOP PRIORITY

◆ FRONT OFFICE & LEADERSHIP

- ◆ **The protection nightmare cost them.** Los Angeles won 11 games but allowed **60 sacks in 2025** — a catastrophic offensive line performance that **overshadowed an 11-6 record** and led to a **3-16 Wild Card loss to New England**.
- ◆ **The loss exposed everything.** In that playoff game, the Chargers managed only 159 passing yards, took 6 sacks, and fumbled once — a systematic failure on the offensive line that can't be ignored.
- ◆ **Mike McDaniel is the fix.** Jim Harbaugh brought in the respected offensive coordinator to redesign the scheme and hopefully improve protection schemes and execution.
- ◆ **Harbaugh's seat gets warmer.** Year 2 of the experiment; another playoff loss and questions about the hire will intensify.

◆ TRADES & MAJOR TRANSACTIONS

- ◆ **SIGNED** **Tyler Biadasz, C** — **#1 priority for offensive line**, addressing the center position that was a weakness in 2025.
- ◆ **SIGNED** **Cole Strange, G** — guard help to stabilize the interior line, pairing with Biadasz.
- ◆ **SIGNED** TE **Charlie Kolar** — **\$24.3M/3yr** for receiving depth and pass-catching support.
- ◆ **RETAINED** **Khalil Mack** kept on the defensive end to anchor the pass rush despite salary considerations.
- ◆ **DRAFT FOCUS** Additional offensive line depth through the draft to complete the overhaul of the unit that gave up 60 sacks.

◆ PLAYER UPDATES & CAMP BATTLES

- ◆ **The offensive line is ground zero.** Tyler Biadasz, Cole Strange, and additional draft picks will be competing to fix a unit that embarrassed itself in the Wild Card game.
- ◆ **Justin Herbert, QB.** A year after avoiding catastrophic injury, Herbert needs competent pass protection to operate. The 60 sacks tell the story of how poorly he was protected in 2025.
- ◆ **Mike McDaniel's scheme test.** The offensive coordinator arrives to fix the protection issues; his first camp will show whether the problem was personnel, scheme, or both.
- ◆ **Khalil Mack, EDGE.** Retained on the defense to keep pass rush consistent, though the offensive line overhaul is the clear priority.
- ◆ **Charlie Kolar, TE.** Added as a pass-catching option to give Herbert more targets in a league where that's increasingly important.

◆ LATEST ROSTER MOVES

MOVE	DETAIL
▲ Tyler Biadasz, C	Center #1 priority, signed
▲ Cole Strange, G	Guard addition for interior
▲ Charlie Kolar, TE	Pass-catching option, 3 yr / \$24.3M
▲ Khalil Mack, EDGE	Retained on defense
▲ OL draft additions	Multiple picks invested in line
▲ Khalil Mack trade consideration	Kept despite salary discussion

◆ THE BOTTOM LINE

Los Angeles allowed 60 sacks, lost a playoff game badly, and called in Mike McDaniel to fix the offense. Tyler Biadasz and Cole Strange address the center and guard spots, but the offensive line rebuild is a work in progress that will dominate this camp. **Jim Harbaugh's second season is already proving to be a prove-it moment; the 3-16 playoff loss erased the 11-6 regular season from the narrative.** If McDaniel's scheme and the new pieces don't immediately improve protection, questions about Harbaugh's long-term fit will grow loudly.